

# Daily Bible Note

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Date: October 7, 2026

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## I. Today's Reading

NKJV: 1 Chronicles 20:1–8

1 It happened in the spring of the year, at the time kings go out to battle, that Joab led out the armed forces and ravaged the country of the people of Ammon, and came and besieged Rabbah. But David stayed at Jerusalem. And Joab defeated Rabbah and overthrew it.

2 Then David took their king's crown from his head, and found it to weigh a talent of gold, and there were precious stones in it. And it was set on David's head. Also he brought out the spoil of the city in great abundance.

3 And he brought out the people who were in it, and put them to work with saws, with iron picks, and with axes. So David did to all the cities of the people of Ammon. Then David and all the people returned to Jerusalem.

4 Now it happened afterward that war broke out at Gezer with the Philistines, at which time Sibbechai the Hushathite killed Sippai, who was one of the sons of the giant. And they were subdued.

5 Again there was war with the Philistines, and Elhanan the son of Jair killed Lahmi the brother of Goliath the Gittite, the shaft of whose spear was like a weaver's beam.

6 Yet again there was war at Gath, where there was a man of great stature, with twenty-four fingers and toes, six on each hand and six on each foot; and he also was born to the giant.

7 So when he defied Israel, Jonathan the son of Shimea, David's brother, killed him.

8 These were born to the giant in Gath, and they fell by the hand of David and by the hand of his servants.

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## II. Key Summary

- In the spring, when kings went out to battle, Joab led the army out, ravaged Ammon, besieged Rabbah and took the city, while David stayed behind in Jerusalem instead of going out with his troops.

- David took the Ammonite king's crown, a talent of gold set with precious stones, carried off a great deal of spoil from the city, and put the people of Ammon to forced labor, doing the same in all their cities before returning to Jerusalem with the army.

- Three separate battles with the Philistines follow: Sibbechai killed Sippai, Elhanan killed Lahmi the brother of Goliath, and Jonathan killed the man with twenty-four fingers and toes who defied Israel; the passage closes by noting that these descendants of the giant of Gath fell by the hand of David and his servants.

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### III. Passage Analysis

The riskiest moments are usually the easiest ones

"Beware of moments and hours of ease. It is in these that we most easily fall into the power of Satan. The sultriest summer days are most laden with blight... Watch and pray in days of vacation and ease, even more than at other times." [1]

The text spends only one line on it — "But David stayed at Jerusalem" — with no explanation, but he wasn't where he was supposed to be, and that's where everything that followed started to go wrong.

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The winners weren't the giants

"The servants of David, though men of ordinary stature, were too hard for the giants of Gath in every encounter, because they had God on their side." [2]

In all three battles the side that won was not the bigger side; Scripture puts the reason in God being with them, not in their height or their strength.

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### IV. Reflection Question

What's one thing you've run into this term that felt so big it was like fighting a giant, where you didn't even know where to start? What exactly was it, and what did you end up

doing?

Sibbechai, Elhanan and Jonathan weren't giants, and they weren't any taller than the men they fought, yet the giants went down one by one — because what settles a fight was never who is bigger, but whose side God is on.

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## References

[1] Enduring Word, David Guzik, Commentary on 1 Chronicles 20 (quoting F. B. Meyer), <https://enduringword.com/bible-commentary/1-chronicles-20/>

[2] Blue Letter Bible, Matthew Henry's Commentary on the Whole Bible, 1 Chronicles 20, [https://www.blueletterbible.org/Comm/mhc/1Ch/1Ch\\_020.cfm](https://www.blueletterbible.org/Comm/mhc/1Ch/1Ch_020.cfm)